

income tax return. This allows you to take the child and dependent care credits to reduce your taxes. See IRS Publication 17 for detailed information on the “head of household” status and a checklist to see if you’re qualified to claim it.

If your income is below the limit, you can also take the earned-income tax credit, which offsets your income tax liability and can sometimes supplement your income by allowing you to get back more than you actually paid. If you have a dependent child living with you, you may want to consult a tax accountant before filing your income tax returns.